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The State of Digital Intelligence 2026

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Front 4 – Multi-Source Fusion & Decision Intelligence

An independent ProductBeacon market briefing on the government & national-security intelligence software market – lawful interception, OSINT/WEBINT, decision intelligence. Front 4 of six.

Disclosures. The author, Yohay Etsion, served as VP Product at Cognyte, which competes in this front (its NEXYTE platform). This chapter is independent ProductBeacon research based **solely on publicly available material**; it reflects the author's personal analysis, not Cognyte's position. **This report does not constitute investment, legal, tax, or accounting advice.** No claim here should be relied upon as the basis for any investment decision. As of June 2026, the author holds no position in any named public security – directly or via a cybersecurity-sector ETF – and is not compensated by any named vendor.

Glossary.

- **Fusion (data fusion)** – the analytical layer that ingests already-collected data from multiple sources and combines it into a single, resolved, relationship-mapped intelligence picture, without itself performing the collection.¹
- **Decision intelligence (DI)** – per Gartner, “a practical discipline that advances decision making by explicitly understanding and engineering how decisions are made, and how outcomes are evaluated, managed and improved via feedback”; a decision-intelligence *platform* composes “data, analytics, knowledge and artificial intelligence (AI) techniques” to support, automate, and augment decisions.²
- **Entity resolution** – the process of determining that records across different sources refer to the same real-world entity (a person, organization, device, or account), consolidating them into a single, accurate view that feeds a knowledge graph.³
- **Link analysis** – the mapping and traversal of relationships between resolved entities – people, organizations, events, transactions – to surface connections, networks, and the significant paths between them, built on an entity-link-property methodology.⁴

4.1 The Playing Ground

Fusion is the front where intelligence stops being about *getting* the data and starts being about *making sense* of it. Every other front in this report produces material: intercepted signals, field-collected geolocation, open-source web extractions. All of that material has to be correlated, de-duplicated, resolved into real-world people and organizations, mapped into relationships, placed in space and time, and turned into something an analyst can act on. That work is fusion. The product an investigative-analytics vendor sells is described, in its own terms, as letting analysts “map and analyze connections between entities such as people, organizations, and events,” built on an “entity-link-property (ELP)

methodology” that “reveals relationships between data entities to discover patterns.”⁴ The market now names the top of this layer *decision intelligence*, which Gartner defines as “a practical discipline that advances decision making by explicitly understanding and engineering how decisions are made,” delivered through a platform that composes “data, analytics, knowledge and artificial intelligence (AI) techniques.”² The buyer is a national-intelligence or national-security agency, a military-intelligence fusion cell, a law-enforcement major-investigations or intelligence unit, a financial-intelligence unit, or a cross-agency task force.

The defining property of this front — the line that keeps the chapter coherent — is that it is an analytical *layer*, not a collection silo. And because fusion by construction touches everything else in the report, the boundary here is the most fragile in the whole study and has to be stated with unusual precision:

Fusion is the analytical LAYER on top of collection, not a peer collection silo; a vendor is graded here ONLY if it sells fusion standalone to bring-your-own-source buyers; collection vendors with built-in dashboards are graded in their collection front and only referenced here.

That sentence does more grading work than any other in the report, so it is worth unpacking what it includes and excludes.

What this front IS. The standalone analytical layer that ingests already-collected data from many sources and turns it into resolved entities, mapped relationships, geospatial and temporal context, and managed investigations. The work spans entity resolution, link and graph analysis, geospatial-temporal analysis, investigative case management, cross-source correlation, and, as the 2026 inflection, AI- and LLM-assisted investigation. The platform is *source-agnostic by design*: it is sold to a bring-your-own-source buyer who already has, or separately procures, the collection. The central product is the resolution-and-graph engine, not the connection to any one sensor.

What this front is NOT. Three boundaries matter.

First, it is *not* a collection silo with a built-in dashboard. A Monitoring Center that ships an analyst console (the Law Enforcement Monitoring Centers front), a deep-packet-inspection appliance with a profiling UI (National Agencies), an IMSI-catcher with a mapping view (Tactical Intelligence), or an open-source collector with a results graph (Open-Source Intelligence) is graded in *its* collection front and only referenced here. The test is whether the vendor sells the fusion layer standalone to buyers who bring their own sources. Palantir, i2, Siren, DataWalk, Nuix, and Cognyte's NEXYTE-as-platform pass that test; a collection box's analytics module does not. This single discipline kills the largest double-counting risk in the report, since almost every collection vendor also markets “analytics,” and counting those modules as fusion contenders would charge the same revenue and the same product to two chapters.

Second, it is *not* the collection itself. Fusion does not tap a channel, deploy a device, or scrape the web; it consumes the *output* of the collection fronts. Where a vendor (Cognyte, Cellebrite, BAE) operates in both a collection front and the fusion layer, its fusion grade rests only on its standalone analytics product, re-sourced to a page that markets that product as a platform.

Third, it is *not* general-purpose business intelligence. Tableau-class dashboards and horizontal commercial “decision intelligence” platforms are decision-support software. The Fusion contender set is the investigative, intelligence-grade subset: entity-centric, relationship-first, provenance-aware, and deployable into accredited government environments. The arrival of an inaugural Gartner “Decision

Intelligence Platforms" Magic Quadrant⁵ validates the *category name* commercially, but the government-intelligence fusion vendors graded here are a distinct, accreditation-gated cohort. The label overlaps; the buyer and the deployment do not.

Three buyer misconceptions

"Fusion is just a nicer dashboard on top of our collection." The hard problem is not visualization. It is entity resolution at scale — deciding that "J. Smith," "Smith, John," and a bare phone number are the same person across millions of records — and relationship inference across heterogeneous sources. Palantir frames the differentiator not as the screen but as the *ontology*: software that "takes an organization's vast, disparate data and formats it into a common and relatable picture," a "semantic layer that integrates the data, logic, and actions of an institution."⁶ The dashboard is the cheap part. The resolution-and-ontology engine is where the switching cost lives, which, as the barriers below show, is exactly why incumbency in this layer is so sticky.

"Whoever collects the data should own the analysis." The market has decisively separated the two. A buyer can run multiple collection vendors — a signals box from one, OSINT from another, lawful interception from a third — into a *single* fusion platform. It increasingly wants to, precisely to avoid being locked into one vendor's full stack. I read the standalone-fusion vendors as structurally betting *against* the vertically integrated collection-plus-analytics vendors on exactly this point. Source-agnosticism is their wedge, and it is also the grading line that defines who belongs in this chapter.

"Centralizing everything into one data lake is the only way to fuse it." This is the live architectural debate of the front. A growing cohort markets *federation* — analyzing data where it lives, without bulk-copying it into a central store — as the answer for sovereignty-, classification-, and governance-constrained buyers. Siren's federation capability, for instance, "enables seamless correlation across multiple distributed data sources... without centralizing them."⁷ The "you must build the lake first" assumption is precisely what the federated camp contests.

The data and technology stack

The stack reads in three strata. An ingestion-and-integration layer pulls from the collection fronts and normalizes their wildly different outputs. A resolution-and-graph core turns normalized records into entities and relationships. An exploitation-and-workflow layer adds geospatial-temporal analysis, case management, governed collaboration, and AI-assisted investigation. The differentiation lives in how well a vendor does the core at scale and how openly it does the ingestion.

On **ingestion**, fusion is downstream of everything. Its inputs are the heterogeneous outputs of the four collection fronts: high-volume signals metadata from the National Agencies, evidentiary warrant-scoped intercept product and chain-of-custody from the Monitoring Centers, time-and-place-stamped field fixes from Tactical Intelligence, and variable-reliability open-web and dark-web extractions from Open-Source Intelligence. To those it adds the buyer's own case files, watchlists, and identity databases. Vendors consume this through connectors and standard interfaces. Siren ingests "using a variety of tools including JDBC and web services," combining "digital forensic data, metadata from audio and video, and call data records... with internal databases to provide a more complete picture."⁷ CognyTE markets that it "Preloads OSINT, BIZINT and commercial data into one intelligence view," fusing "text, image, audio & video files."⁸ I read the connector inventory — how many of the collection fronts' formats a

fusion vendor ingests out of the box — as a plausible but hard-to-verify moat. I also read “fuses any source” claims as directional positioning rather than a disclosed integration surface, unless a vendor ties the claim to a published connector list.

The **resolution-and-graph core** is the genuinely hard part. *Entity resolution* — deciding that records across sources refer to the same real-world entity — is the central capability, with DataWalk describing a “powerful entity resolution facility to ensure an accurate view of connected, consolidated data” feeding “a single knowledge graph,”³ and Cognyte marketing “advanced entity resolution” to “resolve identities and uncover relations.”⁸ *Link and graph analysis* maps and traverses the relationships between resolved entities; “finding the shortest and most significant path across connected records (phone calls, messages, social links)” is described as “a typical example of a widely used investigative graph algorithm.”⁷ *Geospatial-temporal analysis* places entities and events in space and time for pattern-of-life and movement reconstruction.

The **exploitation-and-workflow layer** is where the analyst actually lives. Investigative *case management* is the system of record for an investigation; Nuix Neo markets “Intelligence, Collaboration & Analytics for Investigations.”⁹ *Governed cross-agency collaboration* shares resolved intelligence “across organizational boundaries while maintaining strict governance and permissions.”⁸ That is not a nicety but a deployment prerequisite, because a fusion platform aggregates data of mixed classification and must enforce need-to-know inside one workspace. *AI-assisted investigation*, the 2026 inflection, is framed throughout as positioning rather than verified architecture.

The axes buyers discriminate on

Five dimensions separate the serious fusion vendors, each mapping to a real, publicly observable cost-and-capability structure.

1. **Entity-resolution accuracy at scale.** The accuracy of the resolution core under real-world volume and ambiguity — the difference between a graph that *looks* connected and one whose merges an analyst can defend in court. This is the least externally verifiable axis: no vendor publishes false-merge rates. I read a vendor’s willingness to tie resolution to an auditable provenance trail per edge as the stronger public signal, and the absence of one as a flag.
2. **Federated versus central-data-lake architecture — the central wedge.** Whether a vendor *requires* data to be centralized into its own store or can *federate*: analyze data in place across distributed sources without bulk-copying it. Siren positions explicitly on federation, and the general technical case is that “data federation should be used when data must remain at source due to governance, compliance, sovereignty, or contractual requirements.”⁷¹⁰ I read federation as a genuine architectural wedge specifically for classification- and sovereignty-constrained government buyers. For them, bulk-copying mixed-classification data into one vendor’s lake is itself a security and policy problem, not merely a cost question. If, through H2 2026, federated-architecture vendors publish named government reference wins that explicitly cite data-residency or no-bulk-copy as the selection rationale, the federation wedge hardens from positioning into a procurement-grade discriminator. If those wins do not surface publicly, it stays a marketed architectural preference.

3. **Native-source breadth.** How many of the collection fronts' formats, plus the buyer's internal systems, a vendor ingests out of the box, and how much custom integration each new source costs. The public proxy is enumerated data-type support (NEXYTE's "text, image, audio & video" plus "OSINT, BIZINT and commercial"⁸) versus unquantified "all data" claims, which are positioning, not facts, unless tied to a published connector list.
4. **AI- and LLM-assisted investigation – as positioning, not verified architecture.** An outside party cannot verify a vendor's true internal architecture, so this axis must be read as *how a vendor markets itself*, with a falsifiable test on public proxies. The 2026 market is visibly attaching natural-language and agentic layers over the resolved graph. NEXYTE markets that it "Reveals hidden connections with AI and natural language search,"⁸ Palantir centers AIP, and the broader framing is Gartner's prediction that "by 2027, 50% of business decisions will be augmented or automated by AI agents for decision intelligence."² I read "AI-assisted investigation" as the current category-defining positioning move in fusion – parallel to the OSINT front's "agentic" race – not yet a verified architectural moat. If, by H2 2026, the AI-forward fusion vendors publish named government reference wins or independent (not vendor-asserted) time-to-resolution benchmarks, the claim graduates from positioning to a defensible differentiator. If not, it stays a watchlist item.
5. **Openness and integration versus walled garden.** Whether a vendor is source-agnostic and integration-friendly – ingests rival vendors' collection, exposes APIs, lets the buyer keep multiple collection vendors – or steers the buyer into a single-vendor full stack. The public proxy is explicit "bring your own source" and open-connector positioning (Siren, DataWalk, i2) versus a collection vendor's fusion module that is most valuable atop *that vendor's own* collection. I read this as the axis most correlated with the grading line itself. The more open a fusion product, the more clearly it is a true standalone; the more it presumes the vendor's own collection, the closer it sits to being a collection-front dashboard that should be graded elsewhere.

The public barriers

Fusion's defining barrier is not technology – it is incumbency and switching cost, with no clean analog in the collection fronts. Two structural barriers sit on top of that.

Accreditation as the deployment gate. A fusion platform aggregates mixed-classification data inside accredited environments, so cloud and deployment accreditation is a hard gate for U.S.-federal and allied work. Palantir's posture is the clearest *public* evidence of the bar. It received "FedRAMP High Authorization" for its Federal Cloud Service covering "Palantir's entire product suite including Gotham" (announced December 2024), and holds Department of Defense "Impact Level 5 and 6" authorizations, later extended via "PFCS Forward" to on-premises and edge deployments.¹¹ With an IL6 authorization, "government agencies can fast track use... in place of having to run lengthy and bespoke audit and accreditation processes."¹¹ That means an un-accredited fusion vendor faces a multi-quarter accreditation slog before it can even be deployed, a structural barrier that favors incumbents who already cleared it. One discipline binds throughout: any accreditation or certification claim about a named vendor must cite the certifying body or the vendor's own public statement, never an analyst assertion. A wrong accreditation claim on a named company is a credibility *and* a defamation hit.

Clearance and FOCI. For classified U.S. programs the vendor and its personnel must clear, and foreign ownership is a structural barrier independent of product quality. Contracts requiring access to classified information “will not be awarded to companies operating under foreign ownership, control or influence unless adequate safeguards are in place,” administered through the Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency’s SF 328 process, with mitigation instruments such as “independent directors, visitation and access controls, [and] restrictions on communications with the foreign owner.”¹² In May 2024 the Department of Defense expanded FOCI review “from solely US government contractors that access classified information to all US government contractors performing on certain unclassified contracts with a value exceeding US\$5 million.”¹³ For non-U.S. fusion vendors — Israeli, UK, or EU-headquartered — selling into U.S. classified programs, FOCI is the gate an excellent product cannot route around without a mitigation structure. That is itself a reason cross-border vendors in this market stand up or acquire cleared U.S. delivery entities. The specific magnitude and timeline of any individual vendor’s FOCI posture is an inference from the regime’s general applicability here, not a quoted fact — a thin spot worth naming as one.

Build-versus-buy and Palantir’s incumbent gravity. This is the structural dynamic most specific to fusion, and it has two faces.

The first is *in-house build at the top tier*. The largest national agencies have historically built their own analytics, and the public record on Palantir’s early history notes that “the NSA in particular had been resistant because it had plenty of its own talent,” reflecting “the agency’s historical preference for developing solutions internally.”¹⁴ In-house build is the structural “Tier 0” non-vendor competitor in fusion. At the very top end, the buyer’s alternative to a commercial platform is its own engineering org, which caps commercial penetration of the most sensitive programs.

The second face is *switching cost once a platform is the system of record*. Palantir’s expansion is the public exemplar: from “a single NSA contract” to “the data integration architecture for the Department of Defense, the Department of Homeland Security, the Internal Revenue Service” and beyond. Public reporting puts “\$970.5 million” in U.S. federal contracts in 2025 — “nearly double the prior year,” much of it via “a sequence of no-bid contracts.”¹⁵ The switching cost is the ontology: the “framework that connects disparate data systems into a coherent operational model is what creates switching costs and defensibility.”¹⁶ I read Palantir’s incumbency gravity as the dominant market-structure fact of this front. Challengers (Siren, DataWalk, i2, Nuix) compete substantially on *cost* and *openness against lock-in* rather than on raw capability parity. If, through H2 2026, a federated or cost-positioned challenger publicly displaces an incumbent fusion deployment at a named agency — a named filing, procurement notice, or named-outlet report — the “incumbency is unassailable” read weakens. If challengers keep winning only greenfield and cost-sensitive deployments while incumbents hold the top-tier programs, the gravity read holds.

4.2 The Terrain

Market size: three named markets, walled, never averaged

There is no clean public dollar figure for the government data-fusion software slice. The honest way to present the sizing is to set the public estimates of the *adjacent* markets next to each other and let the spread between definitions speak. The defining problem of this front is structural: no research publisher sells a methodology-disclosed “government data-fusion / decision-intelligence” figure, because publishers size fusion by the buyer’s *vertical* – commercial enterprise, law enforcement, defense – not by the fusion *function*. What exists publicly are three distinct, overlapping markets, each scoped differently. The right discipline is to keep them walled rather than conflate or sum them. All figures are research-publisher numbers and are directional.

The first market is **decision intelligence**, the broadest and most commercial-weighted definition – and the one closest to Cognyte’s own public product category. Treat it as the *outer* bound and the most scope-bled of the three, because the published DI total-addressable-market is dominated by commercial-enterprise decision-support rather than government intelligence.

Publisher	Definition used	Figure (as stated)	CAGR / period
Grand View Research	DI as integrating technology, structured processes, and human expertise; connecting decision support, management, and complex-systems applications	USD 15.22B (2024) → USD 36.34B (2030) ¹⁷	15.4% (2025–2030)
Research and Markets / TBRC	DI software, data feeds, and services for augmented and automated decision-making	USD 17.41B (2025) → USD 20.73B (2026) ¹⁸	19.1% (2025→2026)
Precedence Research	DI across decision support, management, and augmentation	USD 16.34B (2025) → USD 18.91B (2026) → USD 68.20B (2035) ¹⁹	15.7% (to 2032)

The three publishers bracket the 2025 DI market at roughly USD 15.2B–17.4B and the 2026 market at roughly USD 18.9B–20.7B, with CAGRs clustering tightly in the mid-teens to 19% range. I read this as a relatively *converged* number – unusual for this report – precisely because decision intelligence as published is a broad commercial category, the same one in which Gartner ranks enterprise-analytics houses, not intelligence primes. If a fourth methodology-disclosed publisher lands outside USD 14–18B for 2025, the convergence is weaker than I have assumed. The binding caveat: this is the outer commercial bound. The government and national-security fusion slice is a small, opaque sub-fraction of it that no publisher isolates.

The second market is **investigative and crime analytics**, the tightest fit to the front’s law-enforcement buyer – link analysis, cross-case correlation, pattern detection – narrower than DI and explicitly law-enforcement-scoped.

Publisher	Definition used	Figure (as stated)	CAGR / period
Market.us	software platforms for data integration, visualization, and predictive modeling enabling LEA and security orgs to analyze crime data with AI/ML	USD 8.1B (2024) → USD 9.3B (2025) → USD 30.7B (2034) ²⁰	14.2% (2025–2034)
The Business Research Company	crime analytics including predictive-policing solutions	USD 8.25B (2025) → USD 9.4B (2026) ²¹	13.9%

The two crime-analytics publishers bracket 2025 at roughly USD 8.25B–9.3B with ~14% CAGRs – a much tighter clustering than DI, and a smaller base consistent with the narrower scope. I read crime analytics as the single best public proxy for the *law-enforcement* fusion slice specifically, while noting that it still folds in records-management and predictive-policing adjacencies that are not pure fusion. If a publisher with a disclosed methodology ever isolates “link-analysis / investigative-fusion software” below USD 8B for 2025, this proxy over-states the front.

The third market is **defense and big-data analytics**, the relevant anchor for the military-intelligence buyer at the command-and-ISR end.

Publisher	Definition used	Figure (as stated)	CAGR / period
The Business Research Company	big-data analytics in defense and aerospace incl. integrated data management, multi-source acquisition, real-time operational intelligence	USD 9.77B (2025) → USD 11.07B (2026) → USD 18.14B (2030) ²²	13.3% (to 2026)
Global Market Insights	AI and analytics in military and defense	USD 10.42B (2024) → USD 11.53B (2025) → USD 35.78B (2034) ²³	13.4% (2025–2034)

The two defense-analytics publishers bracket 2025 at roughly USD 9.8B–11.5B at ~13% CAGR. A wider public budget figure fixes the demand envelope without being mistaken for a software market: U.S. command-control-communications-computers-cyber-ISR (C5ISR) funding is reported at roughly USD 42.69B for FY2026, an ~11.4% increase.²⁴ I carry the C5ISR figure strictly as a demand-envelope ceiling, never as a market size; it is total program funding, far broader than the fusion-analytics software slice.

These three markets overlap heavily: a Palantir or a Cognyte appears in all three publishers' vendor lists, which is exactly why they must stay walled and **must not be summed**. Summing would triple-count the same vendors and the same revenue. Set side by side, decision intelligence (~USD 15–17B, 2025) is the commercial outer bound, crime analytics (~USD 8–9B) is the law-enforcement proxy, and defense analytics (~USD 10–11B) is the military-intelligence proxy. The spread between them – not within any one – is the finding.

The government slice: a labeled proxy, not a segment size

No clean public dollar figure isolates the government and national-security data-fusion software slice. Given the opacity of B2G intelligence budgets, that is an expected, honest result, not a gap to be filled by invention. The three definitions above bracket adjacent markets. The government-fusion segment is the accreditation-gated subset that sits somewhere inside the crime-plus-defense-analytics envelope and well below the commercial DI total, but no publisher sells that number, and I do not manufacture one. The harder public currency for this front is not any market derivative at all. It is the single named public issuer in it.

That issuer is Palantir, the only pure-play public company in the front. That makes its disclosed *Government-segment* revenue the one hard, filing-grade datapoint here, carried strictly as the disclosed segment, never as a market size and never as total company revenue. For the three months ended 31 March 2026 (Q1 FY2026), Palantir reported Government-segment revenue of **USD 858M**, which it stated grew 76% year-over-year, with U.S. Government revenue at USD 687M (+84%) and International Government at USD 172M (+51%). Total company revenue was USD 1.63B (+85%), carried here only as disclosed company context, not as a fusion-front market figure.²⁵ A single vendor's disclosed government revenue runs at roughly a USD 3.4B annualized rate (four times the disclosed ~USD 858M quarter, stated as arithmetic on the published figure, not a publisher number) and grows 76% year-over-year. I read that as the cleanest public evidence that government fusion and operational-analytics demand is real and accelerating, even though no publisher isolates the segment. If Palantir's Government-segment year-over-year growth decelerates below ~20% across two consecutive quarters through 2026, the "accelerating government fusion demand" read weakens.

Demand drivers

Three forcing functions carry the analytical weight the market numbers cannot.

The data has outrun the analyst. The same gap the collection fronts name from the supply side reappears here from the demand side. The volume and heterogeneity of available data — signals, OSINT, records, geospatial, biometric, financial — has outrun any analyst team's ability to correlate it manually. The defense-analytics publishers frame the driver as "multi-source data acquisition," "integrated data-management platforms," and "real-time operational intelligence."²² The crime-analytics publishers frame it as the need to link and resolve patterns across "diverse data sources."²⁰ Fusion is the layer that monetizes that gap directly, and Cognyte states the need in its own public terms: NEXYTE "Preloads OSINT, BIZINT and commercial data into one intelligence view" and is built to "Fuse and analyze data across sources to resolve identities and uncover relations across datasets."²⁶ The structural point: every new collection source — a new OSINT feed, a new intercept modality, a new biometric database — *increases* the value of the fusion layer that correlates it. The analytical layer's market is a derivative of the collection fronts' growth.

Cross-agency fusion centers are institutionalizing shared analytics. The fusion-center model — a dedicated hub where multi-source data is collected, integrated, analyzed, and disseminated across agencies — is a named, standing institutional buyer of fusion software, distinct from any single agency's own stack. The U.S. operates a network of state, local, and federal fusion centers, and the demand is framed explicitly around eliminating data silos for cross-agency collaboration, with one fusion-center platform vendor publicly claiming adoption by "over 30% of U.S. fusion centers."²⁷²⁸ I read the fusion-

center channel as the structural reason this front has a *cross-agency*, not just per-agency, buyer: the analytical layer is bought specifically to span organizational silos. If 2026–2027 fusion-center procurements consolidate onto in-house or single-prime stacks rather than commercial platforms, the cross-agency commercial-fusion read weakens.

Build-versus-buy is contested at the top tier. The sharpest 2025 public signal on demand structure is the build-versus-buy fight at top-tier agencies, crystallized in Palantir’s GAO protest against the Defense Intelligence Agency. On 30 June 2025 Palantir filed a protest challenging the DIA’s plan to award a sole-source contract for custom in-house software development. The target was the “Prometheus” program, which began as a small-business research project. Palantir argued the approach “violates the Competition in Contracting Act and Federal Acquisition Streamlining Act,” which prefer commercial products. The DIA countered that “it does not have the software rights or documentation that the agency can share with a group of competitors.”²⁹ I read the Prometheus protest as the clearest public expression of the front’s demand fault line — commercial-off-the-shelf fusion platforms versus agency-built custom systems — and as confirmation that the boundary is contestable and recompeting rather than settled. That is exactly what creates the opening commercial vendors press into. If GAO or the courts side with the DIA’s sole-source custom-build rationale, or the pattern repeats at other agencies through 2026, the “commercial COTS displaces in-house build” thesis weakens. If Palantir’s protest succeeds — echoing its 2016 Army DCGS win at the Court of Federal Claims — it strengthens.

The AI and LLM shift

The clearest 2025–2026 public tech signal in fusion is that agentic AI on operational data has become the category benchmark, and Palantir’s AIP is the most-cited public reference point. I frame this strictly as what vendors *publicly claim*, because true architecture cannot be verified from outside.

Palantir’s own public positioning leads: AIP “connects AI with your data and operations” and is “designed to drive automation across operational processes.” It lets organizations “embed large language models (LLMs) and AI agents directly into the systems your teams use every day, enabling them to automate decisions, analyze enormous datasets, and execute tasks,” with builder tools that “enable the development of production-ready AI-powered workflows, agents, and functions.”³⁰ Palantir also states publicly that AIP “provides tools for generating detailed audit trails, explanations, and evaluations of model decisions”³⁰ — the governance framing that matters most for a defense and B2G buyer. The benchmark effect ripples across the rest of the front. Cognyte markets NEXYTE’s “agentic AI-based decision flows” and integrated NEXYTE with Microsoft Azure to enhance its AI data-analytics solution,²⁶³¹ and i2 Group brought “i2 Insights for assisted data importing and analysis” to market in its FY2025.³²

The shared public claim across these vendors is that large-language-model and agentic AI compress the analyst workflow from raw multi-source data to decision-ready output. You cannot verify the true architecture from outside, so the discipline is to treat this as “markets itself as agentic,” not “is agentic.” The observable proxies are public product-page repositioning toward “agentic,” named government accreditations covering the AI product (Palantir’s AIP falls under its FedRAMP High authorization, as the barriers section noted), and named government reference wins. If a fusion vendor’s AI positioning fails to convert into a named, dated government reference win or accreditation through 2026–2027, this trend demotes from a central convergence pillar to a watchlist item. For now, several of these claimants *can* be named from public pages, which is what keeps it a live candidate.

Procurement and accreditation structure

Fusion procurement is bimodal. At the very top tier it tracks the sovereign, sole-source pattern of the collection fronts — custom build versus prime award. The broader law-enforcement and defense-analytics layer is bought through the same accreditation-gated federal vehicles as the rest of government software. Both modes are public-anchorable.

The gating barrier is **federal cloud accreditation**, and Palantir's public history is the cleanest table-stakes anchor. It holds DoD IL5 and IL6 accreditation for its Federal Cloud Service, with the IL6 Provisional Authorization announced 10 October 2022, and was granted FedRAMP High Baseline Authorization on 3 December 2024, stated to cover "the entirety of Palantir's product offerings — including AIP, Apollo, Foundry, Gotham, FedStart, and Mission Manager."³³³⁴ Palantir even markets the accreditation itself as a product through "FedStart," which lets third-party software run inside its "already-accredited environment."³⁵ I read the accreditation stack — IL5/IL6 plus FedRAMP High covering the AI product — as the *real* barrier to entry in the U.S. government fusion market: a software-quality-agnostic gate that favors incumbents who have already paid the accreditation cost. If a new fusion entrant wins a named U.S. classified-workload contract in 2026 without IL5-or-higher accreditation, the accreditation-as-moat read is over-stated.

Above that floor sits the **sole-source-versus-recompete** fault line. At the top tier, fusion procurement splits between multi-year sole-source or custom-build awards and recompeted commercial-product buys, and the line between them is litigated on the public record. The clearest case is the Palantir-versus-DIA "Prometheus" protest, where Palantir invoked the Competition in Contracting Act and the Federal Acquisition Streamlining Act preference for commercial products as the lever to force a sole-source custom award into a recompete.²⁹ I read the recurring protest pattern — the DIA in 2025, echoing the Army DCGS fight Palantir won at the Court of Federal Claims in 2016 — as evidence that the build-versus-buy boundary in government fusion is contested in public, in sharp contrast to the opaque sovereign-system awards of the collection fronts. Below the pure-plays, fusion analytics reaches government through defense primes and integrators (Leidos, GDIT, RTX and peers) and through established federal vehicles such as the GSA Schedule and Carahsoft-class resellers, with the fusion-center channel as a further named buying surface. The primes' fusion-specific dollar exposure is not publicly isolable and is carried here as channel structure, never as a sized figure.

One ownership note bears on the contenders and war-chest analysis that follow. i2 Group — the Analyst's Notebook lineage and the historical link-analysis standard — was divested by IBM to Harris Computer Corporation (announced 4 January 2022). It is now part of Constellation Software, not IBM. The "IBM i2" branding is legacy, and i2 reported a "40% year-on-year increase in bookings" for its FY2025.³²³⁶ Siren's funding status could not be cleanly confirmed in this terrain pass and is flagged for re-verification when the war chests are graded.

4.3 The Contenders

Decision intelligence is the front where the candidate list looks deep and grades shallow. Pull a raw vendor universe for "government fusion" and you can name a dozen contenders without effort, but most of them dissolve the moment you apply the boundary the front is built on. This front is the multi-source *analytical layer* on top of collection: entity resolution, link analysis, geospatial and temporal correlation,

case management, cross-source fusion. The grading test from the playing-ground section is strict and unforgiving: a vendor earns a grade here *only if it sells the fusion-and-analytics layer standalone to a buyer who brings their own sources*. A vendor whose analytics are inseparable from its own collection – a deep-packet-inspection box or a monitoring centre with a built-in dashboard – is graded in its collection front and merely *referenced* here. That single discipline is what keeps this front from becoming a double-counting catch-all, and applying it honestly produces a finding rather than a roster.

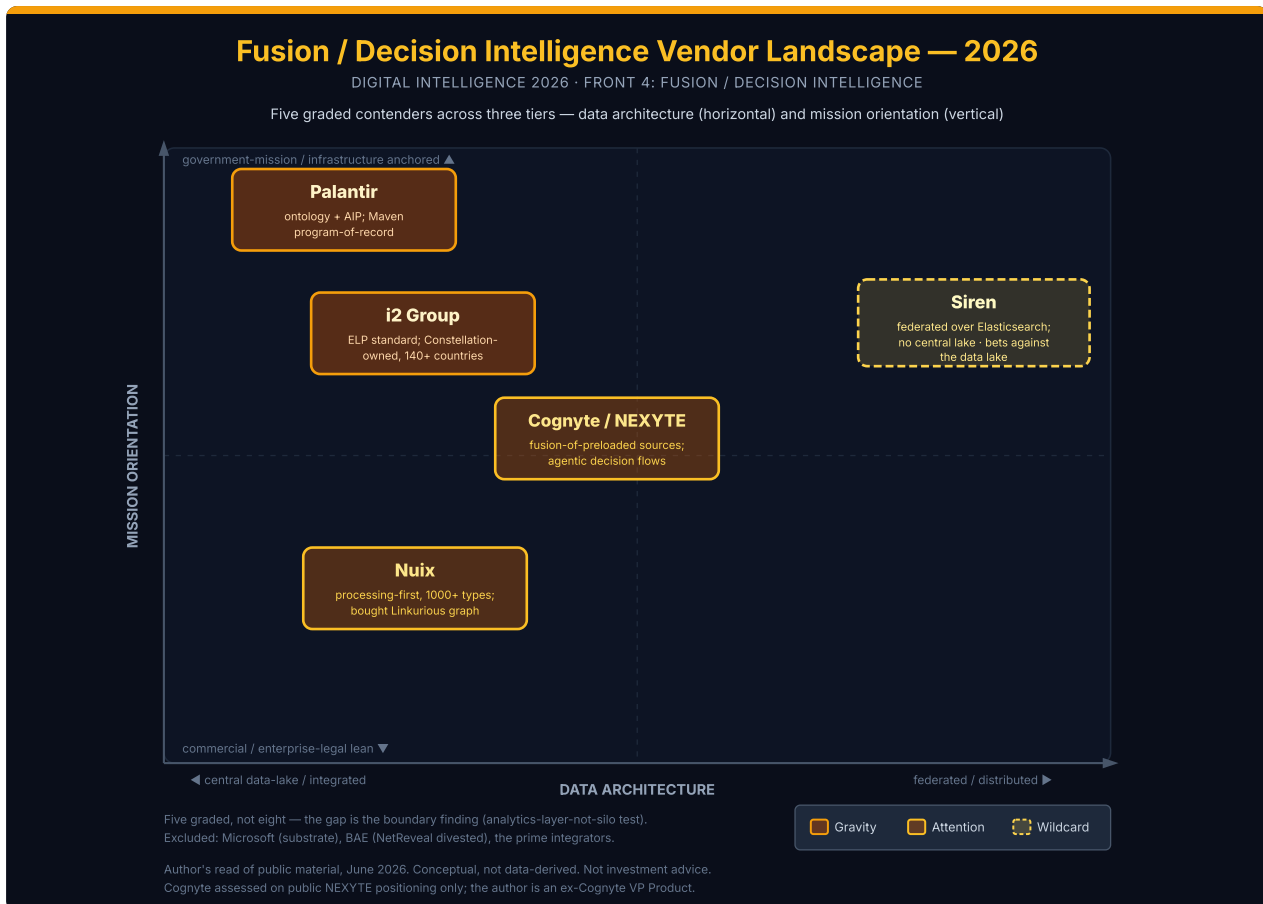
Five vendors are graded, not eight – and the gap is the point. The cap for this report is eight contenders per front. This front comes in under the cap by design, and not because the public material is thin. Each of the five graded here carries a rich, dated public footprint. The vendors that fell out fell out on *architecture-fit*, not on material scarcity. This is the exact inverse of the monitoring-centre and tactical fronts, where the constraint is finding enough gradeable vendors to fill the buckets. Here the constraint is *boundary*: the honest count of vendors that sell the fusion *layer* standalone to government bring-your-own-source buyers is smaller than the candidate list. Stating that plainly is more useful than manufacturing three more grades by relaxing the test. The five are placed across three tiers – 2 Gravity (the structural anchors a buyer cannot map the front without naming), 2 Attention (the vendors shaping 2026 demand, M&A, and the AI-native narrative), and 1 Wildcard (the architecture bet against the incumbents). The candidates that did not make the cut, and why, are documented at the end of this section so the boundary can be defended.

A word on who is *not* graded, because in this front the exclusions are as central as the inclusions.

Microsoft appears on every “government fusion” list, but, on the public record, it does not sell a standalone fusion platform to bring-your-own-source intelligence buyers. Its public posture in this market is as the cloud-and-large-language-model layer *underneath* Palantir. It deploys Foundry, Gotham, and AIP inside Azure Government and classified clouds under an August-2024 partnership.⁵⁴ Azure and Sentinel are a cloud-and-SIEM layer, not a government multi-source investigative-fusion product.

BAE Systems carried the candidate slot on the strength of NetReveal. But NetReveal was *divested to SymphonyAI in 2022* (announced 12 July 2022, closed 31 October 2022),⁵⁵ and BAE no longer fields a standalone government fusion-software product on the public record that fits this front.

The megacap defense primes – **Leidos, GDIT, RTX, Oracle** – are systems-integrator and prime-contractor businesses, not standalone fusion-software products, and they *integrate* fusion software (frequently Palantir or i2) into programs of record, which makes them an integration channel, not a competing platform. All three exclusions are market-force commentary, not grades. The discipline that removed them is the same layer test that admitted the five below.



Author's read of public material, June 2026. Vendor positions are conceptual, not data-derived. Tier color-coding: Gravity (burnt orange), Attention (amber), Wildcard (pale amber). Not investment advice.

Gravity tier

Palantir – the primary

"A commercially-available, AI-ready operating system that improves and accelerates decisions for operators across roles and all domains." — Palantir, Gotham product description, accessed 2026-06-14³⁷

Palantir is the category-defining decision-intelligence platform — the *de facto* standard against which every other vendor in this front is positioned, and the one a buyer cannot map the terrain without naming first. Its Gotham platform is marketed as the government, defense, and intelligence product, with Foundry as the commercial equivalent. The stated wedge is the full stack: data integration through Gotham and Foundry, then an AI operationalization layer. That layer, AIP, launched in 2023, is one Palantir publicly describes as using "generative and agentic AI models, including large language models (LLMs)" directly inside both platforms.³⁸ The public commercial-acquisition engine is the AIP Bootcamp, which converts evaluation into deployment on a customer's own operational data.³⁸ The target buyer is the archetype the layer test is written around: defense, national-intelligence, and military operators who

bring their own data sources and pay Palantir for the fusion-and-decision layer on top. On pricing, the public record is sparse: no clean per-seat figure, only large multi-year government programs of record and enterprise Bootcamp-led commercial deals, with pricing largely dark beyond disclosed contract values. Architecturally, Palantir markets a central-platform-plus-ontology model with AIP positioned as a native generative-and-agentic layer over the ontology rather than a bolt-on. I carry that as positioning, not verified architecture, because true internals cannot be read from outside.

The most consequential public event in this front sits with Palantir. In a 9 March 2026 letter, Deputy Secretary of Defense Steve Feinberg directed that the **Maven Smart System be designated a Pentagon “program of record” across all military branches**. Oversight moves from the National Geospatial-Intelligence Agency to the DoD Chief Digital and AI Office, with the U.S. Army taking future contracting.³⁹ A program-of-record designation is the difference between contestable pilots and locked-in, multi-year core infrastructure at the largest defense buyer in the world. I read this as Palantir hardening from “vendor” to “infrastructure” inside the U.S. defense estate. That raises the switching cost against every rival in this front, and the build-versus-buy play later in this chapter tracks it against public proxies. Sourcing here is the richest in the front: vendor-controlled self-positioning, heavy named-outlet coverage, and SEC-filer disclosure, since Palantir (NYSE: PLTR) is a public issuer and the trading-position disclaimer applies.

i2 Group

“The global industry standard for creating and sharing intelligence ... The knowledge graph solution at the forefront of intelligence analysis.” — i2 Group homepage, accessed 2026-06-14⁴⁰

i2 Group is the legacy link-analysis standard — the incumbent the AI-native disruptors are positioned to displace, and the second name no map of this front can omit. Its Analyst’s Notebook, marketed under the “Intelligence Amplified” line, has been the entity-link-property analyst workbench for decades. It is the tool a vast installed base of NATO, intelligence, and law-enforcement analysts trained on. The method became a *de facto* standard in its own right. i2 positions Analyst’s Notebook as the knowledge-graph solution that helps analysts “discover the mission critical connections between events, locations, and people.”⁴⁰ It extends the single-analyst workbench to an enterprise-fusion environment through its Enterprise Insight Analysis (EIA) platform, publicly described as providing “advanced fusion and multi-dimensional analytics to create actionable intelligence to detect, disrupt, and defeat sophisticated threats” by accelerating teams “through the process of acquiring, fusing, and analyzing data” across “internal, external, and open source data.”⁴¹ The stated moat is incumbency plus the entity-link-property method as an industry standard. The target buyer is defense, law enforcement, national security, and government. That base spans “thousands of organizations” across “more than 140 countries,” including most members of NATO.⁴² On pricing, i2 markets explicitly as “commercial-off-the-shelf (COTS) solutions,”⁴² the accessible-procurement contrast to bespoke sovereign builds, though no clean per-seat figure is public. Architecturally it is graph-native — knowledge-graph at the core, analyst-workbench plus enterprise fusion — and it is adding “AI-enabled analytics”⁴² as a modernization layer over the established graph rather than rebuilding around a large-language-model core. The positioning is “modernize the incumbent standard,” not “replace it.”

The ownership fact matters and is frequently misstated: i2 is **owned by N. Harris Computer Corporation, a division of Constellation Software – not IBM**. Harris acquired the i2 product portfolio from IBM in a deal announced 4 January 2022 (effective 1 January 2022),⁴³ and i2 has operated under Constellation since. The public momentum is real and recent: on 7 October 2025 i2 disclosed “a 40% year-on-year increase in bookings and continued double-digit organic growth across all business segments.”⁴² That followed an August-2024 disclosure of NATO-driven double-digit growth.⁴⁴ The reason i2 grades as Gravity rather than as a fading incumbent is exactly this tension. It is the decades-old standard the AI-native platforms must displace, and the public scorecard shows it still growing double digits while they grow too. The displacement question, framed as a falsifiable conditional in the plays below, turns entirely on i2’s installed base.

Attention tier

Nuix

“Finding Truth in the Digital World ... Leading AI-powered solutions, helping organizations protect, govern and unlock value from their data.” – Nuix homepage, accessed 2026-06-14⁴⁵

Nuix is the processing-first contender – the engine that makes vast, messy, multi-format evidence corpora investigable, sitting at the boundary where eDiscovery meets investigation meets intelligence. Where Palantir is ontology-first and i2 is graph-first, Nuix’s wedge is *unstructured-data processing at investigative scale*. It markets the ability to ingest “over 1000 file types” of “messy unstructured data” and turn it into “structured, searchable assets,”⁴⁵ then apply “investigative analytics and intelligence software” on top, with Nuix Neo Investigations pitched to “uncover the truth with insights on a massive scale.”⁴⁶ The target buyer is “law enforcement, legal firms, government departments and large corporations globally,” with public-record claims of “over 1800 organizations” and “90+ regulators worldwide.”⁴⁵ Nuix is unusual in this front for the transparency its listing forces: it is ASX-listed (NXL), so contract economics are partly disclosed at the annual-contract-value level – a rarity here. Architecturally it markets a processing-engine core (its own “bespoke language models,” the 1000-plus file-type span) with the Neo platform as the modern analytics-and-AI layer over the top. It is adding graph and link-analysis through acquisition rather than a native rebuild.

The 2026 surface is the most active in the Attention tier. Nuix’s first-half-FY26 results, reported 23 February 2026, showed revenue of AUD 121.2 million (up 15% year-on-year) and a return to net profit. The Neo platform surged 148% year-on-year to roughly 20% of total annual contract value (total ACV AUD 234.4 million).⁴⁷ Most relevant to its grading here, Nuix **signed to acquire Linkurious SAS for €20 million on 3 December 2025** (approximately €7 million in ACV, positive EBITDA). That folds graph and link-analysis directly into its unstructured-data processing engine.⁴⁸ I read this as the inorganic route to a complete fusion stack: a processing-first vendor buying the graph-analytics layer to move up-stack into full fusion, against i2’s organic incumbency and Palantir’s built ontology. It is a clean buy-the-layer move that materially strengthens Nuix’s claim to be graded as a fusion platform rather than a processing tool.

Cognyte (NEXYTE)

Disclosure: the author, Yohay Etsion, served as VP Product at Cognyte. This is independent ProductBeacon research based solely on publicly available material; it reflects the author's personal analysis, not Cognyte's position, and is not investment advice.

"Accelerate data-driven decision-making with data fusion and advanced analytics ... Fuse and analyze data across sources to resolve identities and uncover relations ... Apply agentic AI-based decision flows." – Cognyte, NEXYTE Decision Intelligence Platform page, accessed 2026-06-14⁴⁹

Cognyte is graded in this front strictly on its publicly-marketed NEXYTE decision-intelligence platform plus its corporate positioning, sourced entirely to dated public pages with no internal knowledge. This front is the cleanest of the five for grading it, because NEXYTE is publicly buildable as a standalone fusion platform on its own product page. NEXYTE is marketed under the line "EVERY DECISION COUNTS" as a platform that fuses and analyzes "data across sources to resolve identities and uncover relations" and applies "agentic AI-based decision flows."⁴⁹ The corporate frame describes Cognyte as "a global leader in investigative analytics software that empowers a variety of government and other organizations with Actionable Intelligence for a Safer World™."⁵⁰ The publicly-readable USP is that NEXYTE passes the layer test directly. It markets data fusion, identity resolution, and relation analytics to bring-your-own-source buyers as a standalone decision-intelligence workspace, leaning on "preloaded OSINT, BIZINT and commercial data into one intelligence view"⁴⁹ – a fusion-of-pre-integrated-sources pitch rather than a bring-nothing analytics shell. The target buyer, per the public pages, is law enforcement, national security, defense, and financial-crime and anti-money-laundering investigators. That sits within a base of "hundreds of customers in approximately 100 countries."⁵⁰ Architecturally, NEXYTE markets "domain-specific, pre-trained AI models," "co-pilots," and "agentic decision flows"⁴⁹ – a positioning move toward AI-native decision intelligence. Whether the underlying architecture is large-language-model-native or a bolt-on cannot be verified from outside, so this is read as positioning only, the same standing caveat that governs every contender in this front.

A scope note matters here. Cognyte is graded as *one contender among many* on its public NEXYTE surface alone. Its broader portfolio breadth – the fact that its public capability pages span multiple of this report's five fronts – is carried by the Convergence chapter rather than force-graded into each front. Here the question is simply whether NEXYTE is a standalone fusion platform on the public record, and it is. Cognyte (NASDAQ: CGNT) is a public issuer, so the trading-position disclaimer applies, and the author-independence banner above governs the grading.

Wildcard tier

Siren

*“Accelerate the Intelligence Lifecycle with Siren ... dashboard analytics, search and unstructured content processing, alerting, link analysis, entity resolution, integrated natural language processing (NLP), and artificial intelligence (AI).” – Siren, Law Enforcement and Intelligence page, accessed 2026-06-14*⁵¹

Siren is the Wildcard because it bets against the one architectural assumption every Gravity-tier vendor is built on – the central data lake. Rather than ingesting everything into a single platform store, Siren federates over data where it lives. Its differentiating technology, Siren Federate, “enhances Elasticsearch with complex join operations and powerful data-linking capabilities, allowing seamless data correlation across multiple indices,”⁵² and the platform markets “investigative intelligence” as search-plus-graph-plus-correlation across distributed sources to enable “intelligence-led policing investigations.”⁵¹ That is the stated USP and the architecture-disruption story of the front in one move: if federated fusion can match central-lake performance at investigative scale, it undercuts the heavy-integration model the incumbents sell. The target buyer is law enforcement and intelligence agencies across national security, public safety, fraud and compliance, and cyber-threat operations.⁵¹ Pricing is private and not publicly disclosed; an aggregator funding lineage circulates but is carried here as undisclosed rather than as a fact. Architecturally Siren is explicit that it is *not* central-lake: a federated knowledge-graph over Elasticsearch doing “real-time big data correlations (joins) within Elasticsearch clusters.”⁵² Entity resolution is added through a Senzing partnership announced 15 October 2024,⁵³ and U.S. public-sector distribution runs via an Elastic OEM partnership and Carahsoft.⁵²

Consistent with the Wildcard discipline, the read stays descriptive and hedged. Siren is private (headquartered in Galway, Ireland), and its 2024–2026 momentum is partnership-led – the Senzing entity-resolution partnership and the Elastic public-sector OEM, not a disclosed funding milestone or a named program win. The interesting bet is whether federated fusion pulls budget away from the central-lake incumbents, or stays a specialist architecture for agencies that cannot or will not centralize their data. I do not assert which way it breaks. The plays below frame it as a falsifiable conditional grounded on whether a named government agency publicly adopts a federated-fusion architecture for a mission previously run on a central lake.

The cut line – why three candidate categories are not graded here

The front’s apparent depth forces a defensible cut, and here the cut is made by the layer test, not by the cap. Each candidate below is real and publicly sourced; each is excluded because it does not sell the fusion-and-analytics layer standalone to a bring-your-own-source buyer, and each is placed where it actually fits.

- **Microsoft** – fails the standalone-fusion-to-BYO-source test. Its public role here is the Azure Government and large-language-model layer *underneath* Palantir. That role follows the August-2024 classified-cloud partnership deploying Foundry, Gotham, and AIP inside Azure Government and

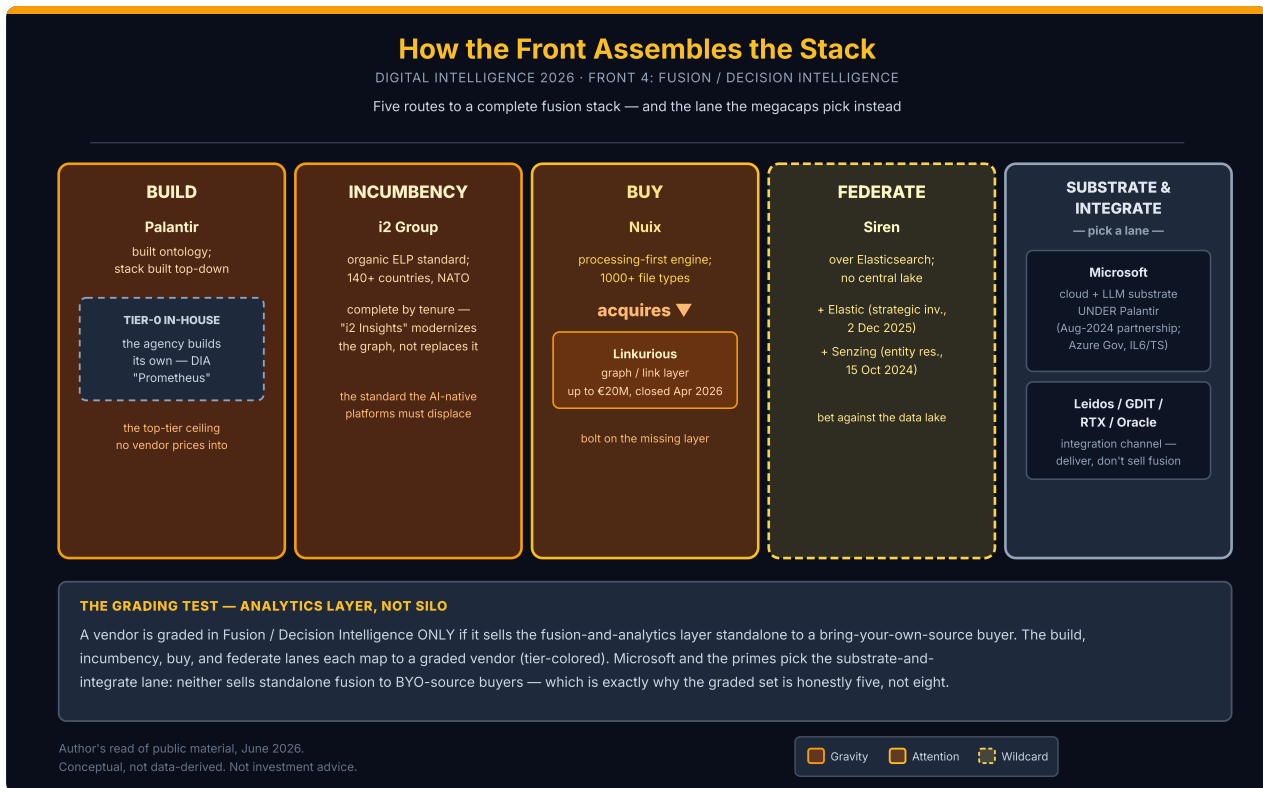
IL6/Top-Secret clouds.⁵⁴ Carried as hyperscaler-layer commentary in the plays section, not as a graded fusion vendor.

- **BAE Systems** — its fusion-relevant analytics asset, NetReveal, was *divested to SymphonyAI in 2022* (announced 12 July 2022, closed 31 October 2022).⁵⁵ No current standalone government fusion product on the public record fits this front, so BAE is referenced in the plays section as a market-structure datapoint — the divestiture itself is the signal — and not force-graded.
- **Leidos / GDIT / RTX / Oracle** — systems integrators and prime contractors that *deliver* fusion software into programs (frequently Palantir or i2) rather than selling a standalone fusion product to BYO-source buyers. Sized at disclosed-segment level only and referenced in the plays section as the integrator and build channel; never graded.

A note on what is deliberately *not* a problem here: there is no surveillance-cohort exclusion to make in this front. None of the locked never-graded vendors (NSO, Candiru, Intellexa, Ability, Voyager Labs) competes in standalone government fusion, so none appears in the candidate set. **Cellebrite** is graded in the tactical front on its device-extraction collection — the product the buyer pays for — and is only *adjacent* to this front via its analytics layer. Per the cross-front ledger it is referenced here rather than re-graded, to avoid double-counting a vendor whose collection, not its analytics, is what the buyer pays for. The discipline that holds the graded set at five is the same discipline that keeps every one of these placements honest: grade the layer, reference the rest.

4.4 Their Plays

Five strategic moves are in motion across the Fusion / Decision Intelligence front in 2026. Each is anchored to a dated public event, names its participants, and carries a falsifiable read grounded on a publicly observable proxy. Those proxies are a Pentagon designation memo, an earnings or bookings disclosure, a named M&A close, a strategic-investment announcement, or a public procurement record. Two of the five are consolidation plays (one M&A at the graph layer, one strategic-investment-led federation bet). One is the front's central build-vs-buy displacement contest, one is the government program-of-record lock-in, and one is the structural "pick-a-lane" pattern that keeps the hyperscalers and primes out of the standalone fusion layer. Collection vendors that "wear a fusion hat" — DPI/monitoring-center boxes with a built-in dashboard — appear in this section only as commentary on the front's boundary, never as graded fusion contenders, per the analytics-layer-not-silo test.



The five routes to a complete fusion stack, mapped to the plays in this chapter. Author's read of public material, June 2026. Conceptual, not data-derived. Not investment advice.

Play 1: The Category Leader Converts Pilots Into Permanent Infrastructure

- Observation.** Palantir's Maven Smart System was directed for designation as a Pentagon "program of record" across all military branches, per a 9 March 2026 letter from Deputy Secretary of Defense Steve Feinberg. Oversight transfers from the National Geospatial-Intelligence Agency to the DoD Chief Digital and AI Office, with the U.S. Army taking future contracting.⁵⁶⁵⁷ The designation moves Maven from contestable, renewable pilots toward locked-in, multi-year "core digital infrastructure," securing stable funding at the largest defense buyer in the front. It runs alongside the U.S. Army's TITAN multi-sensor data-fusion award to Palantir, reported at roughly \$178M⁵⁸.
- Participants.** DoD / CDAO, U.S. Army, NSA, Palantir (NYSE: PLTR).
- My read.** I read this as the category leader hardening from "vendor" to "infrastructure" inside the U.S. defense estate — the single most consequential government event on the front, because program-of-record status raises the switching cost against every rival and converts a recomputed line item into a standing one.
- Falsifiable read.** *If H2 2026 brings a second allied government designating a Palantir platform as a standing program of record (not a renewable pilot), the infrastructure thesis strengthens into a pattern. If instead public procurement records show a named agency dual-sourcing fusion — running i2 or a federated alternative alongside Palantir on the same mission — the lock-in is less complete than the program-of-record framing implies.*
- Evidence.** DepSecDef Maven program-of-record memo, 9 Mar 2026, widely reported across defense-trade and national press⁵⁶⁵⁷; U.S. Army TITAN award reported at roughly \$178M per defense

reporting⁵⁸.

Play 2: The Build-vs-Buy Displacement – AI-Native Platforms Pressure the Legacy Link-Analysis Standard

- **Observation.** The front's central tension is whether AI-native ontology/operationalization platforms displace the decades-old entity-link-property (ELP) analyst workbench, or whether the incumbent standard modernizes and holds its base. On one side: Palantir's AIP-led operationalization positioning⁵⁹ and the Maven program-of-record scale above⁵⁶. On the other: i2 Group's countervailing public disclosure of "a 40% year-on-year increase in bookings and continued double-digit organic growth across all business segments" (7 Oct 2025)⁶⁰, and Nuix's Neo platform ACV surging 148% YoY in 1H FY2026.⁶¹ The public scorecard is **mixed** – both the AI-native disruptor and the incumbent standard are growing double digits at the same time.
- **Participants.** Palantir, i2 Group / Constellation Software, Nuix, and the NATO / law-enforcement ELP installed base.
- **My read.** I read this as displacement-at-the-margin, not wholesale replacement – yet. The honest reading is that the disruptor and the incumbent are both winning, which is why this play scores MIXED. The incumbent's installed base across "more than 140 countries"⁶⁰ is a real moat, and the AI-native platforms have not published the named "rip-and-replace" reference wins a clean displacement thesis would require. A parallel datapoint shows that government fusion procurement is genuinely contested: the U.S. Defense Intelligence Agency's "Prometheus" open-source data-analytics acquisition drew a GAO bid protest, the public marker that even AI-native-era fusion awards are litigated and recompeted, not simply handed to the category leader⁶².
- **Falsifiable read.** *If through H2 2026 i2's public bookings growth decelerates while Palantir or Nuix publish named government reference wins that explicitly replace a legacy link-analysis deployment, the displacement thesis hardens. If instead i2 keeps posting double-digit bookings growth and publishes its own AI-native modernization with named retention wins – and contested awards like Prometheus continue to be recompeted rather than sole-sourced to an AI-native incumbent – the "incumbent standard modernizes and holds" read wins.*
- **Evidence.** Palantir AIP positioning⁵⁹; i2 40% bookings growth, 7 Oct 2025⁶⁰; Nuix Neo +148% ACV, 1H FY26⁶¹; DIA "Prometheus" GAO protest⁶².

Play 3: Buy the Graph Layer – Fusion Vendors Acquire Link-Analysis to Complete the Stack

- **Observation.** Nuix completed its acquisition of Paris-based graph-intelligence platform **Linkurious SAS for up to €20M**, the transaction having closed in April 2026 following French foreign-direct-investment approval. The deal folds graph/link-analysis (~€7M ACV) into its unstructured-data processing engine.⁶³⁶⁴ The disclosed structure was €12.5M upfront cash plus €2.5M escrow shares plus a €5M ACV-linked earnout, an A\$~35M headline.⁶⁴ The signed-to-acquire announcement dated to 3 December 2025⁶³.
- **Participants.** Nuix (ASX: NXL), Linkurious, and government / law-enforcement / enterprise investigation buyers.

- **My read.** I read this as the M&A route to a complete fusion stack for vendors that lead on one layer and lack another — a processing-first vendor buying the graph-analytics layer to move up-stack into full fusion, against i2's organic incumbency and Palantir's built ontology. It is the inorganic path to the collect-process-link-decide workflow, and the corrected €20M close price marks it as a bolt-on-scale tuck-in rather than a transformational deal.
- **Falsifiable read.** *If H2 2026 brings a second comparable acquisition of a graph/link-analysis or entity-resolution specialist by a fusion-adjacent vendor, the buy-the-layer pattern is the front's consolidation mode. If instead these acquired graph capabilities surface only as bolt-on features without named government wins, the build (Palantir) and incumbency (i2) routes are out-competing the buy route.*
- **Evidence.** Nuix-Linkurious signed 3 Dec 2025⁶³; close (up to €20M), Apr 2026⁶⁴.

Play 4: Federated Fusion Emerges as the Alternative to the Central Data Lake

- **Observation.** A standalone strategic-investment signal arrived for the federated-architecture bet: **Elastic (NYSE: ESTC) announced a strategic investment in Siren on 2 December 2025**, deepening a decade-long partnership and explicitly framed around AI-driven investigations for national security. The round size was not disclosed⁶⁵. Siren's Federate technology enhances Elasticsearch with join operations and data-linking to correlate across distributed sources rather than ingesting everything into one central store⁶⁶. Entity resolution is added via a Senzing partnership (announced 15 October 2024)⁶⁷, and US public-sector distribution runs through the Elastic OEM relationship and Carahsoft⁶⁶.
- **Participants.** Siren, Elastic, Senzing, and agencies constrained — by data sovereignty, scale, or governance — from centralizing their data.
- **My read.** I read this as a genuine architectural counter-bet with a narrow-but-real beachhead, not yet a mainstream displacement. The federated model is the most direct public challenge to the central-platform model the Gravity tier (Palantir, i2) is built on. Consistent with Wildcard discipline, the read stays descriptive. The open question is whether federated fusion pulls budget from the central-lake incumbents or stays a specialist architecture for agencies that cannot or will not centralize.
- **Falsifiable read.** *If through H2 2026 a named government agency publicly adopts a federated-fusion architecture for a mission previously run on a central-lake platform, the federated thesis graduates from specialist to contender-architecture. If federated deployments stay confined to data-residency-constrained niches without a named central-lake displacement, it remains a Wildcard architecture rather than a category shift.*
- **Evidence.** Elastic strategic investment in Siren, 2 Dec 2025⁶⁵; Siren Federate / Elasticsearch-join architecture⁶⁶; Siren-Senzing partnership, 15 Oct 2024⁶⁷.

Play 5: Hyperscalers and Primes Pick a Lane — Cloud-and-Channel, Not Standalone Fusion

- **Observation.** The largest adjacent players are positioning around the fusion layer rather than competing in it head-on. The August-2024 Palantir-Microsoft partnership deploys

Foundry/Gotham/Apollo/AIP inside Azure Government and classified clouds (IL6 and Top Secret). Microsoft is the cloud-and-LLM layer beneath Palantir, not a standalone fusion product sold to bring-your-own-source buyers.⁶⁸ In parallel, the systems-integrator and prime channel (Leidos, GDIT, RTX, Oracle) *integrates* fusion software — frequently Palantir or i2 — into programs rather than fielding its own standalone fusion platform.

- **Participants.** Microsoft (NASDAQ: MSFT), Palantir, the prime integrators (Leidos / GDIT / RTX / Oracle), and government buyers.
- **My read.** I read this as the hyperscalers and primes ceding the fusion-platform layer to specialists while monetizing the layers above and below it — the base layer (cloud + LLM) for Microsoft, the integration channel for the primes. The fusion-platform layer itself stays a structurally distinct specialist software market, even as the base layer and the channel concentrate. This is the structural reason Fusion’s gradeable contender set is honestly smaller than the raw candidate list: the megacaps that look like fusion players on a vendor map fail the standalone-to-BYO-source test and sit in this commentary instead.
- **Falsifiable read.** *If H2 2026 brings a hyperscaler launching a named standalone government fusion/decision-intelligence product (not a partner-hosting deal), the “ceding the layer” read weakens and the front faces a megacap entrant. If the partnership-and-integration pattern holds — base layer plus channel, no standalone product — the specialist fusion-software market stays structurally distinct from its cloud and integrator neighbors.*
- **Evidence.** Palantir–Microsoft classified-cloud partnership, 8 Aug 2024⁶⁸; systems-integrator channel (Leidos / GDIT / RTX / Oracle), referenced as the build/integration channel, disclosed-segment level only, never graded.

Market-force commentary: the divested and the collection-vendors-wearing-a-fusion-hat (not graded)

Two non-graded structures shape the front’s boundary. First, **BAE Systems** is named only as market-structure context. Its fusion-relevant analytics asset, NetReveal, was divested to SymphonyAI (announced 12 July 2022, closed 31 October 2022)⁶⁹, so BAE no longer fields a standalone government fusion software product on the public record that fits this front. The divestiture is itself the datapoint, no grade and no pattern claim. Second, the collection vendors that market a “fusion” dashboard on top of their own DPI or monitoring-center collection are referenced here, not graded. Per the layer test, a vendor whose analytics are inseparable from its own collection grades in its collection front (National Agencies, Monitoring Centers, or Tactical Intelligence) and is only *referenced* here. Cognyte’s portfolio-breadth across all five fronts is carried by the Convergence chapter, and in Fusion it is graded cleanly and only on its publicly-marketed NEXYTE decision-intelligence platform, not by importing its collection products into the fusion grade.

4.5 War Chests & Casualties

A snapshot of the capital behind the Fusion / Decision Intelligence front: recent rounds and public status, public valuations or disclosed-segment figures, the strategic investors and owners, and any distress signal that meets the evidentiary bar. Every figure traces to a named outlet, a filing, or the vendor's own dated press release. Public-company figures (PLTR, NXL, BA.L, CGNT) are taken at the **disclosed-segment level** where the claim is about the fusion business, never an internal revenue mix. Where a public parent does not break out the relevant unit (Constellation Software and the i2 line), the table records "not broken out" rather than estimating. Private-vendor figures (Siren) appear only where a named outlet or the company's own dated release reports them. The Distress Signal column is populated only where a same-paragraph public footnote anchors a specific event; absent that, it reads "none observed." Live market caps are deliberately not fixed here; instead they are reported at the disclaimer-governed figure on the publication date.

Vendor	Most Recent Round / Public Status (dated)	Valuation / Disclosed-Segment Figure (public only)	Strategic Investor or Owner	Distress Signal (-gated)
Palantir (US – NYSE: PLTR; decision-intelligence platform, Gotham / Foundry / AIP)	Public (NYSE: PLTR) . Q1 FY2026 (qtr ended 2026-03-31): Government revenue \$858M, +76% YoY (US Government \$687M, +84%; International Government \$172M, +51%); total revenue \$1.63B, +85% ⁷⁰⁷¹	Government-segment revenue \$858M/qtr is the disclosed-segment anchor for the fusion claim ⁷⁰ . >\$4B cash, zero debt (Jan 2026) ⁷² . <i>Live market cap reported disclaimer-governed at publication date.</i>	Publicly traded; no controlling strategic owner. Maven made a DoD program of record (Mar 2026 memo) ⁷³ ; US Army TITAN fusion award ~\$178M ⁷⁴	None observed – at scale, accelerating government growth
i2 Group (UK/US – Analyst's Notebook / EIA / iBase; link-analysis & fusion)	Owned by N. Harris Computer / Constellation Software (TSX: CSU) since 2022 (acquired the i2 portfolio from IBM, closed 2022-01-04) ⁷⁵ . Public 2025 self-positioning: "40% year-on-year increase in bookings," double-digit organic growth ⁷⁶	Not broken out. Constellation/Harris does not disclose i2-line revenue or segment financials – i2 financials undisclosed , recorded as such rather than estimated ⁷⁵	Constellation Software (TSX: CSU) via N. Harris Computer; i2 operates as an autonomous Harris business unit ⁷⁵	None observed – parent publicly frames i2 as a growth unit; no public distress event
Nuix (AU – ASX: NXL; investigative analytics / Nuix Neo)	Public (ASX: NXL) . 1H FY2026 (six months to 2025-12-31): revenue A\$121.2M, +15% YoY ; statutory net profit A\$11.1M; Nuix Neo ACV +148% ⁷⁷ . Acquired Linkurious (graph intelligence), closed Apr 2026, up to €20M (A\$~35M) ⁷⁸	1H FY26 revenue A\$121.2M is the disclosed anchor ⁷⁷ . <i>Live market cap reported disclaimer-governed at publication date.</i>	Publicly traded; no controlling strategic owner	None observed – return to statutory profit + accretive M&A
Siren (IE – investigative-intelligence / federated knowledge-graph fusion)	Private. Strategic investment from Elastic (NYSE: ESTC), announced 2025-12-02 , deepening a decade-long partnership; round size not disclosed. ⁷⁹ Total raised ~\$35.4M across	Not disclosed for the 2025 round. Prior aggregator last-priced reference ~\$25.4M (directional, not load-bearing) ⁸¹	Elastic (NYSE: ESTC) (strategic investor, Dec 2025); prior backers incl. Atlantic Bridge, Frontline Ventures, Enterprise Ireland ⁷⁹⁸²	None observed

Vendor	Most Recent Round / Public Status (dated)	Valuation / Disclosed-Segment Figure (public only)	Strategic Investor or Owner	Distress Signal (-gated)
	6 rounds (Crunchbase, directional) ⁸⁰			
BAE Systems (UK – LSE: BA.L; Digital Intelligence within Cyber & Intelligence)	Public (LSE: BA.L / OTC: BAESY). FY2025 (to 2025-12-31): group sales +10.0% (constant FX) to £30.7B; Cyber & Intelligence segment sales ~£2.4B ⁸³	Cyber & Intelligence ~£2.4B is the disclosed-segment level – Digital Intelligence is reported within it, not as a standalone line ⁸³ . <i>Live market cap reported disclaimer-governed at publication date.</i>	Publicly traded UK prime; no controlling strategic owner	None observed (NetReveal fusion asset divested to SymphonyAI in 2022 – market-structure datapoint, not distress) ⁸⁴
Cognyte (IL – NASDAQ: CGNT; investigative analytics / NEXYTE; public-positioning only per)	Public (NASDAQ: CGNT). Last full-year actual – FY2026 (ended 2026-01-31): revenue \$400.0M, +14.1% YoY ; Q4 \$106.2M (+12.4%); GAAP net income +\$4.6M; GAAP operating income +\$13.3M (turnaround from prior-year op loss \$5.1M); adj. EBITDA \$48.2M (+65.7%) ⁸⁵⁸⁶ . Most recent in-window print – Q1 FYE27 (three months ended 2026-04-30, reported 2026-06-03): revenue \$105.5M (+10.4%) , adj. EBITDA \$13.6M (+31.5%) ; FY2027 revenue guidance reaffirmed at ~\$448M ($\pm 3\%$, ~12% growth) ⁸⁷	FY2026 revenue \$400.0M is the last-full-year disclosed anchor; Q1 FYE27 \$105.5M is the current in-window print ⁸⁵⁸⁷ . <i>Live market cap reported disclaimer-governed at publication date.</i>	Publicly traded; no controlling strategic owner	None observed – returned to GAAP profitability; Q1 FYE27 revenue +10.4%, guiding to growth

Commentary on the capital pattern (≤150 words)

Fusion splits cleanly into a **public-company core and a thin private tail**. The graded fusion contenders are overwhelmingly public or public-owned: Palantir (PLTR), Nuix (NXL), BAE (BA.L) and Cognyte (CGNT) trade on exchanges. i2 sits inside Constellation Software (CSU)⁷⁵. Palantir is the scale outlier. Government revenue of \$858M/qtr growing 76%⁷⁰ dwarfs the specialists' annual figures (Cognyte

\$400M FY⁸⁵; Nuix A\$121.2M 1H⁷⁷; i2 undisclosed), and its >\$4B cash, zero-debt balance sheet⁷² gives it build-vs-buy optionality the specialists lack. The 2025–2026 capital signal is **consolidation at the analytics layer, not greenfield funding**: Nuix bought graph-intelligence firm Linkurious (up to €20M, closed Apr 2026)⁷⁸. The lone notable private event — Siren — was a **strategic investment from Elastic** (Dec 2025)⁷⁹ rather than a priced venture mega-round. Standalone private fusion bets are scarce.

4.6 Winning & Losing

Three patterns govern who is gaining ground and who is ceding it on the fusion / decision-intelligence front in 2026. Each is anchored to a specific public event, framed explicitly as opinion, and stated as a falsifiable prediction the next two quarters will confirm or refute. Read them in sequence. The first is the gravitational fact of the front: one vendor is hardening from supplier into infrastructure, and there is a public test of whether that grip holds. The second is the consolidation move every challenger is making in response: buying or federating the graph layer to assemble a complete stack. The third is the unresolved contest underneath both: whether the decades-old link-analysis standard gets displaced by the AI-native platforms, or modernizes and keeps its base. The scorecard on that last one is genuinely mixed, and the chapter says so.

Pattern Claim 1 – The Palantir-Gravity Thesis

Observation. In March 2026 the U.S. Deputy Secretary of Defense directed that Palantir’s Maven Smart System be designated a Pentagon “program of record” across all military branches, moving oversight to the DoD Chief Digital and AI Office and the U.S. Army for future contracting. That converts a sequence of pilots into stable, multi-year core infrastructure.⁸⁸ The scale underneath the designation is filing-grade: Palantir reported Government-segment revenue of \$858M for the quarter ended 31 March 2026, up 76% year-over-year (U.S. Government \$687M, +84%), against a >\$4B-cash, zero-debt balance sheet.^{89 90} The deployment moat is publicly observable. Palantir holds FedRAMP High authorization stated to cover “the entirety of Palantir’s product offerings – including AIP, Apollo, Foundry, Gotham, FedStart, and Mission Manager,” plus DoD Impact Level 5 and Impact Level 6 authorizations.^{91 92} Independent analysis of the platform frames the switching cost as the ontology – the “framework that connects disparate data systems into a coherent operational model is what creates switching costs and defensibility.”⁹³

My read. I read this as one vendor hardening from “vendor” into “infrastructure” inside the U.S. defense estate, on three reinforcing public legs. The first is a program-of-record designation that locks in multi-year funding. The second is a Government-segment revenue line that dwarfs every specialist in the front. The third is an accreditation ledger (FedRAMP High + IL5/IL6 covering the AI product) that is itself a software-quality-agnostic barrier to entry. The challengers in this front – i2, Nuix, Siren – compete substantially on cost and openness-against-lock-in rather than on raw capability parity, because the gravity is structural, not merely competitive. The single most important public test of whether that grip is total runs through the build-vs-buy fault line: the Palantir-DIA “Prometheus” GAO protest (filed 30 June 2025). In that protest, Palantir challenged the Defense Intelligence Agency’s plan to award a sole-source contract for custom in-house software development, arguing the approach “violates the Competition in Contracting Act and Federal Acquisition Streamlining Act.” DIA countered that “it does not have the software rights or documentation that the agency can share with a group of competitors.”⁹⁴ The in-house build remains the genuine Tier-0 competitor at the very top tier, and the boundary is contestable, not settled.

Conditional prediction. *If H2 2026 brings a second allied government designating a Palantir platform as a standing program of record (not a pilot), or the DIA “Prometheus” custom-build path is forced back into a commercial recompetes on the public record, the gravity thesis hardens into the defining structure of the front. The inverse runs two ways: public procurement records show a named agency dual-sourcing fusion – running i2 or a federated alternative alongside Palantir on the same mission – or GAO/courts sustain DIA’s sole-source custom-build rationale and the in-house-build pattern repeats at other top-tier agencies. On either path the lock-in is less complete than the program-of-record framing implies, and the build option is reasserting itself at the ceiling Palantir cannot price into.*

Sources. ^{88 89 90 91 92 93 94}

Pattern Claim 1 — The Palantir-Gravity Thesis

DIGITAL INTELLIGENCE 2026 · FRONT 4: FUSION / DECISION INTELLIGENCE

One vendor hardening from "vendor" into "infrastructure" — on three reinforcing public legs



Author's read of public material, June 2026. Conceptual, not data-derived. Not investment advice.

Pattern Claim 2 – The Layer-Consolidation Thesis

Observation. Across 2025–2026 the fusion front’s challengers moved to complete the stack by acquiring or federating the graph / entity-resolution layer rather than building it organically. Nuix – a processing-first vendor whose engine ingests “over 1000 file types” of unstructured data – signed to acquire Paris-based graph-intelligence specialist Linkurious for up to €20M (signed 3 December 2025, completion April 2026 following French FDI approval), folding link-analysis directly into its platform.^{95 96} On the architectural flank, Siren markets the federated alternative: its Federate technology “enhances Elasticsearch with complex join operations and powerful data-linking capabilities, allowing seamless data correlation across multiple indices” without centralizing the data.⁹⁷ Siren assembled its entity-resolution capability through a Senzing partnership (announced 15 October 2024) and a strategic investment from Elastic (announced 2 December 2025), the latter “to advance AI-driven investigations for national security.”^{98 99}

My read. I read this as two routes to the same destination – a complete collect-process-link-decide workflow – chosen by vendors that lead on one layer and lack another. Nuix takes the inorganic route: buy the graph layer outright and bolt it onto a best-in-class processing engine. Siren takes the architectural route: federate over data where it lives and partner in entity resolution, betting specifically on the classification- and sovereignty-constrained government buyer. For that buyer, bulk-copying mixed-classification data into one vendor’s lake is itself a security and policy problem, not merely a cost question. Both are competing against Palantir’s built ontology and i2’s organic incumbency by assembling the missing layer rather than out-engineering the whole stack. The capital signal of 2025–2026 confirms the pattern: the fusion front’s money is going into consolidation at the analytics layer – Nuix folding in Linkurious, Siren taking a strategic check from Elastic – not into greenfield standalone bets, which are scarce.

Conditional prediction. *Two triggers would confirm the thesis: a second comparable acquisition of a graph / link-analysis or entity-resolution specialist by a fusion-adjacent vendor in H2 2026, or a named government agency publicly adopting a federated-fusion architecture for a mission previously run on a central-lake platform – explicitly citing data-residency / no-bulk-copy as the selection rationale. Either one confirms layer-consolidation as the front’s defining consolidation mode and graduates the federated wedge from positioning into a procurement-grade discriminator. The inverse holds if the acquired graph capabilities show up only as bolt-on features without named government reference wins, and federated deployments stay confined to data-residency-constrained niches without a named central-lake displacement. On that path the build (Palantir) and incumbency (i2) routes are out-competing the assemble-the-layer route, and consolidation is a financing story rather than a competitive realignment.*

Sources. ^{95 96 97 98 99}

Pattern Claim 2 — The Layer-Consolidation Thesis

DIGITAL INTELLIGENCE 2026 · FRONT 4: FUSION / DECISION INTELLIGENCE

Two routes to one destination — assemble the missing layer rather than out-engineer the whole stack

A complete collect-process-link-decide stack
the full fusion workflow both routes are assembling

ROUTE A — INORGANIC / BUY

Nuix (ASX: NXL)

processing-first · 1000+ file types

acquires ▼

Linkurious (graph / link-analysis, ~€7M ACV)

up to €20M · signed 3 Dec 2025 · closed Apr 2026

ROUTE B — ARCHITECTURAL / FEDERATE

Siren (IE)

federates over Elasticsearch · no central lake

+ Senzing

entity resolution
(15 Oct 2024)

+ Elastic investment

strategic check
(2 Dec 2025)

...BOTH COMPETING AGAINST THE TWO ALREADY-COMPLETE INCUMBENTS

Palantir — built ontology

stack built organically, top-down

i2 — organic incumbency

the ELP standard, complete by tenure

Capital signal: the front's money is going into consolidation at the analytics layer — not into scarce greenfield standalone bets.

FALSIFIABLE TEST

If H2 2026 brings a second comparable acquisition of a graph / entity-resolution specialist by a fusion-adjacent vendor, or a named government agency adopts federated fusion for a mission previously run on a central lake — citing data-residency / no-bulk-copy as the rationale — layer-consolidation is confirmed as the front's mode and the federated wedge graduates to a procurement-grade discriminator. If acquired graph capabilities surface only as bolt-on features without named government wins, and federation stays in residency niches, the build (Palantir) and incumbency (i2) routes are out-competing the assemble route.

Author's read of public material, June 2026. Conceptual, not data-derived. Not investment advice.

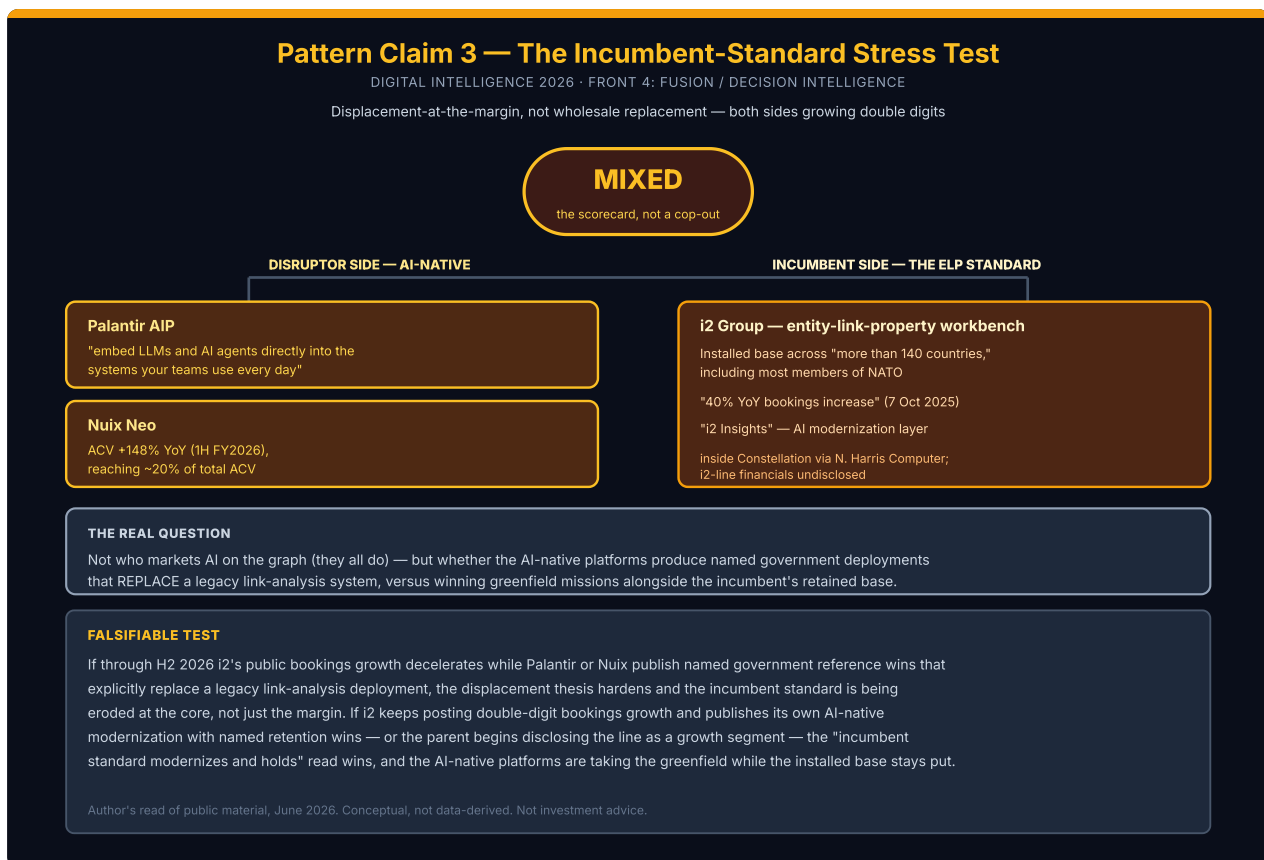
Pattern Claim 3 – The Incumbent-Standard Stress Test

Observation. The front's central tension is whether the AI-native operationalization platforms displace the decades-old link-analysis standard, or whether the incumbent standard modernizes and retains its base. The public scorecard is mixed, with both the disruptor and the incumbent growing double digits. On the disruptor side, Palantir positions AIP as the layer that lets organizations “embed large language models (LLMs) and AI agents directly into the systems your teams use every day,”¹⁰⁰ and Nuix Neo's ACV surged 148% year-over-year in its first half of FY2026 as the platform reached roughly 20% of total ACV.¹⁰¹ On the incumbent side, i2 Group – whose installed base spans “more than 140 countries,” including most members of NATO – disclosed “a 40% year-on-year increase in bookings and continued double-digit organic growth across all business segments” (7 October 2025).¹⁰² It brought “i2 Insights for assisted data importing and analysis” to market as its AI-enabled modernization layer over the established graph.¹⁰³ i2 sits inside Constellation Software via N. Harris Computer (acquired from IBM in 2022), which does not break out the i2 line, so its segment financials are recorded as undisclosed.¹⁰⁴

My read. I read this as displacement-at-the-margin, not wholesale replacement – yet – and that hedge is the finding, not a failure to commit. Both halves of the contest are posting double-digit growth from public disclosures: Palantir/Nuix on the AI-native operationalization story, i2 on incumbency plus an AI-enabled modernization of the same graph core it has shipped for decades. The legacy moat here is real and quantifiable. A NATO-wide installed base trained on one methodology is a switching cost no homepage repositioning erases in a quarter, which is why I score this MIXED rather than calling a winner. The genuine question is not who markets AI on the graph (they all do) but whether the AI-native platforms can produce named government deployments that explicitly *replace* a legacy link-analysis system, as opposed to winning greenfield missions alongside the incumbent's retained base.

Conditional prediction. *If through H2 2026 i2's public bookings growth decelerates while Palantir or Nuix publish named government reference wins that explicitly replace a legacy link-analysis deployment, the displacement thesis hardens and the incumbent standard is being eroded at the core, not just the margin. If i2 keeps posting double-digit bookings growth and publishes its own AI-native modernization with named retention wins – or the parent begins disclosing the line as a growth segment – then the “incumbent standard modernizes and holds” read wins, and the AI-native platforms are taking the greenfield while the installed base stays put.*

Sources. ^{100 101 102 103 104}



Author's read of public material, June 2026. Conceptual, not data-derived. Not investment advice.

Winners, Watch, Losers

Winners.

- **Palantir.** The scale and momentum outlier of the front, on filing-grade evidence: \$858M of Government-segment revenue in the quarter ended 31 March 2026, up 76% year-over-year.⁸⁹ The momentum is reinforced by the Maven program-of-record designation (March 2026)⁸⁸ and a U.S. Army TITAN multi-sensor data-fusion award reported at roughly \$178M.¹⁰⁵ The Winners label is opinion-labeled and scoped to the public momentum and accreditation position, not to the resolution of the build-vs-buy contest that the Palantir-gravity conditional flags as the open test.
- **Nuix.** Returned to statutory profit and growing the modern layer fast: revenue of A\$121.2M in the half to 31 December 2025 (+15% YoY), statutory net profit of A\$11.1M, and a Nuix Neo ACV up 148% YoY. That growth is paired with an accretive, named acquisition (Linkurious) that buys the graph layer it lacked.^{101 95} I read Nuix as winning the "assemble the complete stack inorganically" position, with its ASX-disclosed financials a rare fusion-front transparency that lets the label rest on numbers rather than positioning.

Watch.

- Cognyte.** Graded public-only: its NEXYTE platform markets “data fusion and advanced analytics” with “agentic AI-based decision flows” to bring-your-own-source buyers.¹⁰⁶ Its FY2026 results (year ended 31 January 2026) show revenue of \$400.0M (+14.1%) and a return to GAAP operating income of \$13.3M from a prior-year operating loss.^{107 108} On 3 June 2026 Cognyte reported Q1 FYE27 revenue of \$105.5M (+10.4%) with adjusted EBITDA of \$13.6M (+31.5%), and reaffirmed FY2027 revenue guidance of roughly \$448M (±3%).¹¹¹ On public evidence Cognyte has cleanly turned to GAAP profitability and is guiding to growth, which is a constructive public posture. It is placed on Watch rather than labeled a winner because the author served as VP Product at Cognyte. The public-only discipline of this report keeps the assessment to what filings and product pages disclose, no further. Watch signal: a named government reference win for NEXYTE-as-fusion-platform, or the next disclosed quarter (Q2 FYE27) testing the reaffirmed FY2027 growth guide.
- Siren.** The federated-architecture bet, the Wildcard precisely because it contests the central-data-lake assumption the Gravity tier is built on. Its 2025–2026 momentum is partnership-led (Senzing for entity resolution, Elastic for capital and US public-sector OEM distribution, Carahsoft for federal availability).^{98 99} It rests on a privately held base whose funding is recorded as undisclosed for the 2025 round.¹⁰⁹ Watch signal: a named government agency adopting federated fusion for a mission previously run on a central-lake platform — the threshold that would graduate the architecture from specialist to contender — or, conversely, federated deployments staying confined to data-residency niches.

Losers.

No graded Fusion contender earns a Losers label in this section. A vendor reaches this line only when a cited public event anchors a vendor-specific decline, per the casualty-evidence discipline: a layoff specific to the fusion business, a missed quarter, a down-round, a named executive departure framed as distress, or a customer-churn disclosure. The public events on this front are momentum and consolidation, not failure. Palantir, Nuix, and Cognyte are all growing on disclosed financials; i2's parent publicly frames it as a growth unit; Siren took a strategic investment rather than a distress raise. One market-structure datapoint sits near this line but does not earn a label: BAE Systems divested its fusion-relevant analytics asset, NetReveal, to SymphonyAI (announced 12 July 2022, closed 31 October 2022).¹¹⁰ That is a portfolio exit from standalone government fusion software, which is why BAE is referenced as market structure and not graded as a contender, not a casualty event. Quarterly refreshes will populate this line if a fusion-specific distress signal emerges on the public record.

4.7 The Campaign Ahead

Five watchlist items for H2 2026. Each names a public, observable threshold that would trigger re-assessment of a claim above.

- 1. A second program-of-record designation, or a forced “Prometheus” recompetete.** Signal to monitor: an allied government designating a Palantir fusion platform as a standing program of record (not a pilot), or the GAO/court outcome of the Palantir-DIA “Prometheus” sole-source custom-build protest. Threshold for re-assessment: a second program-of-record designation, or DIA's custom-

build path forced back into a commercial recompile → Pattern Claim 1's gravity thesis hardens. Inverse threshold: a named agency dual-sourcing fusion against Palantir on the same mission, or GAO/courts sustaining DIA's sole-source custom build with the pattern repeating elsewhere → the in-house-build ceiling is reasserting. Primary source: DoD/CDAO and Army procurement records, GAO decision postings, named-outlet defense coverage (DefenseScoop, Washington Technology).

2. **A second graph / entity-resolution acquisition by a fusion-adjacent vendor.** Signal: M&A announcements naming a fusion or fusion-adjacent acquirer of a graph, link-analysis, or entity-resolution specialist, following the Nuix-Linkurious template. Threshold: one such deal announced in H2 2026 → Pattern Claim 2's layer-consolidation thesis is confirmed as the front's consolidation mode. Inverse: acquired graph capabilities surfacing only as un-referenced bolt-on features → the buy-the-layer route is being out-competed by build and incumbency. Primary source: vendor press releases, ASX/SEC filings, named-outlet M&A coverage.
3. **A named federated-fusion displacement win.** Signal: a named government agency publicly adopting a federated architecture (Siren-class) for a mission previously run on a central-data-lake platform, explicitly citing data-residency or no-bulk-copy as the selection rationale. Threshold: one such named win in H2 2026 → the federation wedge graduates from positioning into a procurement-grade discriminator (Pattern Claim 2's first branch). Inverse: federated deployments staying confined to data-residency-constrained niches with no named central-lake displacement → federation remains a specialist architecture. Primary source: agency procurement notices, vendor reference-win press, Carahsoft/Elastic public-sector coverage.
4. **The legacy-standard scorecard – i2 bookings versus a named displacement.** Signal: i2's next public bookings/growth disclosure set against any named government reference win in which an AI-native platform explicitly replaces a legacy link-analysis deployment. Threshold: i2 bookings growth decelerating while Palantir or Nuix publish a named legacy-replacement win → Pattern Claim 3's displacement branch hardens. Inverse: i2 sustaining double-digit bookings growth, publishing AI-native modernization with named retention wins, or Constellation beginning to disclose the i2 line as a growth segment → the incumbent-modernizes-and-holds branch wins. Primary source: i2 Group / Constellation Software disclosures, named government reference-win coverage.
5. **An AI-positioning claim converting to a named, accredited government win.** Signal: whether the front's agentic-AI positioning (Palantir AIP, Cognyte NEXYTE "agentic AI-based decision flows," i2 Insights) converts into a named, dated government reference win or an accreditation explicitly covering the AI product, as distinct from homepage repositioning. Threshold: one vendor publishes such a named reference or AI-product accreditation through H2 2026 → the AI-native claim graduates from positioning to a defensible differentiator. Inverse: "agentic" remaining uniform marketing language across the front with no named-outcome win → the AI-native pillar demotes to a watchlist label rather than a central claim. Primary source: vendor newsrooms (Palantir, Cognyte, i2), FedRAMP/DoD authorization postings, federal procurement records.

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Disclosures

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